

Getting your home ready for photography

Your photographs are the first thing a buyer sees, and most of them will decide whether to inspect based on the images alone. An hour of preparation is worth more than any amount of editing afterwards.

Why we ask, and what we will not do. We photograph homes honestly. We do not add lawns, remove powerlines, alter views or change what a property actually is. That means the room has to be ready before the shutter opens, because we will not fix it later. It also means buyers arrive at your inspection expecting exactly what they saw.

Inside

THE WEEK BEFORE

- ☐ **Declutter benches and surfaces.** Kitchen benches clear apart from one considered item. Bathroom vanities empty.
- ☐ **Clear the fridge.** Magnets, photos, school notices, all of it.
- ☐ **Reduce, do not rearrange.** Fewer things in a room reads as more space.
- ☐ **Replace dead globes,** and match the colour temperature in each room. Mixed warm and cool light is the hardest thing to correct.
- ☐ **Put personal photographs away,** along with anything valuable or identifying.
- ☐ **Clean windows inside and out.** They show more than you would think.

Outside

THE WEEK BEFORE

- ☐ **Mow, edge and weed.** Book a week ahead so cut lines have settled.
- ☐ **Pressure-wash paths and the driveway** if they are marked.
- ☐ **Coil hoses, store tools, tidy the shed surrounds.**
- ☐ **Pool cleaned and the cover off.**
- ☐ **Set outdoor furniture** as you would for guests, with cushions on.

The day before

DO NOT LEAVE THESE TO THE MORNING

- ☐ **Beds made with pressed linen.** Iron the top third if nothing else, that is what the camera sees.
- ☐ **Fresh towels, folded and matching,** in every bathroom.
- ☐ **Bins out of sight,** including the kitchen bin.
- ☐ **Cars off the driveway and away from the frontage.** Ask a neighbour if you need to.
- ☐ **Toys, pet bowls, beds and litter trays** put away.
- ☐ **Flowers or greenery** if you like them. One arrangement, not five.

On the morning

TWENTY MINUTES, NO MORE

- ☐ **Every blind and curtain open,** fully.
- ☐ **Every light on,** including rangehood and under-cabinet.
- ☐ **Toilet seats down, doors ajar** as we will style them.
- ☐ **Benches wiped, sink empty and dry.**
- ☐ **Pets out of the house** if you can manage it.

What we take care of

- Your agent will be there for the whole shoot. You do not need to direct the photographer.
- Styling adjustments on the day, cushions, chairs, the small moves that make a frame work.
- If we use virtual furniture or a day-to-dusk conversion, it is disclosed on the listing. Always.
- If the weather ruins a hero shot, we reschedule it at our cost, not yours.

Tell your agent the three things you love most about the home. Those get the extra frames.